



If an animal is to pass on *advantageous genes* it must survive long enough to BREED. If successful, this results in individuals that are better adapted to their environment. Breeding usually involves *finding a mate* and RAISING YOUNG until they can fend for themselves. *But not all animals do it this way.*



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RABBITS mature fast and breed quickly completing their life cycle rapidly.

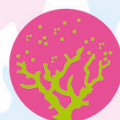
to
BREED



Be your own mate—certain animals such as slugs, snails, clams, and scale insects, can produce both eggs and sperm. They are called hermaphrodites. If no partner is available they can fertilize their own eggs, but usually only do this as a last resort.



Change sides—some animals change their sex at a certain stage in their life or if conditions threaten survival of the group. This mainly happens among fish, frogs, and other hermaphrodite animals.



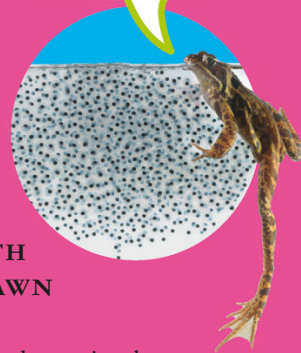
Synchronized spawning—hard corals synchronize their reproductive activity so that neighboring colonies release their eggs and sperm into the water at the same time. The currents mix them up, then carry the fertilized eggs away to form new colonies. Some fish do the same, coming together in huge shoals to release their eggs and sperm.

BRINGING UP BABY

When it comes to producing babies animals have two strategies—they either have a lot or just a few. Animals that don't raise their young tend to have many offspring to allow for the fact that not very many will live to become adults and reproduce.

Female frogs produce a lot of eggs in a jelly mass called frog spawn. These are fertilized by the male and grow into tadpoles and, unless they get eaten, turn into frogs.

999 eggs—**HOPEFULLY** some will survive without my help.



FROG WITH SPAWN

The amount of time that animals spend caring for their young depends on how quickly they reach a stage where they can take care of themselves. Large-brained social animals such as humans and elephants tend to give birth to single offspring, because their babies need time to grow and learn.

HUMANS

